

 PREMIER® POLICY	TITLE: Communicating with Third-Parties Policy	
	DATE CREATED: 07/19/2011	VERSION NUMBER: 3
	DATE OF LAST REVIEW: 12/17/2019	DEPARTMENT OWNER: Corporate Compliance

Printed copies are for reference only. Please refer to the electronic copy for the latest version.

1. Purpose

To provide guidance when approached by third-party companies requesting participation in surveys and/or interviews to discuss general information about the industry or a specific area of expertise. This policy does not reflect activities related to benchmarking information requests that may come from members, suppliers or other organizations designed to compile and share best practices.

2. Scope

Applies to all workforce members of Premier, Inc. and controlled subsidiary companies ("Premier").

POLICY

1. Premier employees are often approached by third-party companies requesting participation in surveys and/or interviews to discuss general information about the industry or a specific area of expertise.

Example email from a third-party company:

Company "X" is conducting a paid survey of experts on medical purchasing. They want to understand best practices for hospital and group purchasing of medical devices, particularly in orthopedics and spinal implants. Are you able to spend an hour on the phone sharing your experience? It's a great opportunity to spend a little time sharing your knowledge with interested and insightful people. I'm sure you're very busy as well, so we can offer you a \$100-\$500 honorarium or charitable donation in your name as a token of our appreciation for the time you spend on the phone.

If you're interested in being considered for this project, please follow this link and click "register as a knowledge leader." We need standardized bios and up-to-date contact info.

The purpose of the consultation is to generate ideas about best practices and the state of affairs, and you won't be asked any questions about your employer. Also, please refer me to any friends or colleagues who can assist us - we will provide you a \$100 finder's fee if they do a call with us.

2. Such requests may come in the form of an email or a phone call to join a group where information is shared related to Premier and/or the industry.
3. These third-party companies often offer to compensate Premier employees for their time and expertise.
4. All such requests to participate in surveys and/or interviews to discuss general information about the industry or a specific area of expertise must be declined.
5. Speaking to financial service firms is expressly prohibited. These types of survey and interviews could potentially set employees up for social engineering attacks from outsiders who start asking seemingly trivial questions but move ahead during the conversation to move proprietary topics where disclosure of information would have a negative impact on Premier's competitive position.